level enhanced machines can wash clothes better thanks to a variety of sensors such as moisture detection, fabric sensors and remote operations. Modern machines can alert users on their personal mobile devices the status of the wash as well as be remotely activated. Washing dishes in a machine isn't a typical Indian habit but with the right technology it could very well become one. The same conveniences we find in washing machines translate to cleaning dishes. The ability to alert, sense and activate remotely not only makes it convenient but also easy to schedule during the day.

Similar technological techniques can be used for automated vacuum cleaners that roam around household surfaces like pets. One such device - the Zumba - has already impressed many with its automated cycle of covering all floors without requiring constant monitoring. But taking it to the next generation would display a level of intelligence that not only cleans but does so as it realises a mess has been made. By utilising its link to the household network, a cleaner on the Internet of Things would be alerted when something is spilled or broken, and it would jump to action. By reacting immediately rather than in a zombie like fashion, we would find the trusty butler we've always wanted ever since the Jetsons.

Functions: monitoring, energy efficiency and maintenance

But most of these features just seem like indulgences or vanities to the lay person. This isn't an incorrect reaction - do we really need this level of automation? Well, that is for each individual to decide for themselves, but it must be known that this automation has its advantages - such as lower electricity bills and a greener environment. Since these technologies rely on sensors that measure every little details essential to their operation, they can be programmed to be as energy efficient as possible. Wouldn't it be great if a fridge that was practically empty powered down and didn't keep going at full blast? What about a washing machine that can regulate the water temperature and spin cycle at a custom level depending on mass and types of clothes? Each of these types of options makes for lesser energy consumption which leads to lower bills and a more greener environment.

The constant monitoring of the machine, its activities and the environment also has added benefits in the form of self-maintenance. A machine that is designed to sense as much as possible can be instructed to detect faulty performance and adjust its output accordingly. Specially in a country like India where something as simple as electric voltage can vary or fluctuate an intelligent home machine is able to insulate itself on early detection or